Maximize My Retirement

This file has two parts. The Tasks part tells you what to do. The Controls and results part tells you what each label means.

You are the person named by **Year of Birth**. Your spouse is the person named by **Spouse Birth Year**. The planner uses 2026 tax amounts. It does not keep the plan when you close the page.

Tasks are:

- Enter the household
- Enter an account
- Read a year
- Choose Roth conversions
- Save the plan

Look up a label in Controls and results. That part is not a procedure.

Tasks

Enter the household

Use **Personal Information** on the left.

1. Enter **Year of Birth**. The hint under the field shows your age in 2026.
2. Set **Filing Status** to **Single** or to **Married**.
3. If **Filing Status** is **Married**, enter **Marriage Year** and **Spouse Birth Year**.
4. Enter **Longevity (Primary)**. If you are married, enter **Longevity (Spouse)**.
5. Enter **Retirement Year**. Contributions and the start of withdrawals follow that year. The rules are under Accounts.
6. Type other income in **Adjusted Gross Income**. The **AGI** column is a different number. Both are defined in Controls and results.
7. Leave **Only the first year** clear. The amount applies every year.
8. Select **Only the first year** to apply that income in 2026 only. Later years use $0.
9. Enter **Social Security**, or **Social Security (combined)** if you are married. Then enter **Start Age**, from 62 to 70. **Start Age** is your age, not your spouse's age.
10. Choose **State**.

If **Filing Status** changes, open each HSA and read **Annual Contribution**. That field resets.

Enter an account

If you are married, choose **Primary** or **Spouse** first. Then choose the account.

1. Choose **Roth IRA**, **HSA**, **401(k)**, or **Taxable**. **Spouse** has no **Taxable** tab. The household taxable account is under **Primary**.

2. Turn the account on with the switch in the card header. Off, the account is left out and its balance counts as $0.
3. Enter **Current Balance** and **Rate of Return**.
4. Enter **Annual Contribution**. The limit in the label is the 2026 IRS limit at your age today. The planner does not reduce a contribution above that limit.
5. On a **401(k)**, enter **Employer Match** if you have one. The match grows 3% a year.
6. For an HSA, set **Stop Contributing at Age**. Roth IRA, 401(k), and Taxable contributions stop in **Retirement Year** instead.
7. Set **Start Withdrawing at Age**.
8. To withdraw a percent of the balance, turn on **Use %**.
9. To withdraw a fixed number of dollars, leave **Use %** off. Type the amount in **Annual Withdrawal**.

Read a year

The cards, the chart, and the table are on the right.

1. Read the four cards above **Portfolio Growth**. The card names are in Controls and results.
2. Open **Year-by-Year Projection**. Stay on **Summary**, or choose **Roth IRA**, **HSA**, **401(k)**, or **Taxable**.
3. Click a year in **Summary**. **How the spendable amount was calculated** uses that year.
4. Click a year on the **401(k)** tab. **How IRMAA was calculated** uses that year.
5. Drag the right edge of a heading to resize that column.
6. Point at a year on **Portfolio Growth**. The tip shows each ending balance and the total.

Choose Roth conversions

The switch is on your **401(k)** only. It is labeled **Maximize ending money**. Your spouse's **401(k)** has the conversion limits, and it does not have this switch.

1. Turn on **Maximize ending money**. If both conversion periods for a person were off, that person's periods turn on. Both brackets become 37%. **Pay Roth Conversion Taxes from Taxable Account** turns on. You and your spouse are each changed this way. A person who already had a period on keeps those settings.
2. Set **Maximize at age** to your age for the result you care about. The table still runs through longevity. After this age the planner adds no more conversions.
3. To count a 401(k) or HSA dollar after cash-out cost, leave the slider at **Spendable**.
4. To count that dollar in full, move the slider to **Total**.
5. Release the slider. The search uses the place where you release it.
6. Turn off **Pre-RMD Roth Conversions** to block conversions before required distributions.
7. Turn off **RMD Roth Conversions** to block conversions from the required-distribution age on. A required distribution still happens.
8. On a period you leave on, choose the bracket and **IRMAA Bracket Cap**.
9. Turn on **Pay Roth Conversion Taxes from Taxable Account** to pay that person's conversion tax from the taxable account.
10. Turn that switch off to withhold the conversion tax from the Roth conversion.

Read the status box under the title while the switch is on.

- A blue status box means the table is still changing. It reads "Maximizing. The table updates as a better plan is found."
- A green status box means the conversions are a proven maximum at **Maximize at age**.
- An amber status box reads "Showing the best plan found. The exact search did not finish, so this may not be the proven maximum."

The exact search stops after 60 seconds. If **Pay Roth Conversion Taxes from Taxable Account** is on and the taxable account cannot cover the tax, the exact search drops that plan. The status box can then be amber.

Save the plan

The page starts from the same sample each time you open it. Unsaved edits are gone when you leave.

1. Click **Save** to download `retirement-plan.json`.
2. Click **Load** and choose that file to bring the plan back.
3. Click **Copy** to put the plan on the clipboard.
4. Click **Paste** to load the text on the clipboard.

If the plan on the page has changed, **Load** and **Paste** ask "Are you sure? This will replace the plan on this page." Cancel to keep the plan on the page. The status then reads "Load canceled".

A file that is not JSON shows "Not valid JSON." A file that is not a plan shows "This is not a retirement plan."

Controls and results

This part describes the screen. It does not tell you which values to choose.

Personal information

Year of Birth. Your age in 2026 is 2026 minus this year. The hint under the field shows that age.

Filing Status. The choices are **Single** and **Married**. **Married** shows marriage fields, spouse longevity, and a **Spouse** set of accounts.

Retirement Year. You are retired in this year and after it. Roth IRA, 401(k), and Taxable contributions stop then. Changing this year also writes **Stop Contributing at Age** and **Start Withdrawing at Age** on the Roth IRA, the 401(k), and the taxable account. It writes **Start Withdrawing at Age** on each HSA. It does not change HSA **Stop Contributing at Age**.

Longevity (Primary) and **Longevity (Spouse).** The table runs through the later of the two deaths. Years are labeled with your age. If your spouse lives longer, your age in the last row is past your own longevity.

Marriage Year. A year before this uses single filing. Your spouse is not in the plan yet.

Spouse Birth Year. This year sets your spouse's age. The hint shows that age in 2026.

Adjusted Gross Income. This field is other income, such as wages, a pension, or interest. It is not the **AGI** column.

Only the first year. When the box is checked, **Adjusted Gross Income** applies in 2026, and later years use $0. When the box is clear, the amount applies every year. The box starts clear. A plan saved before this box existed also applies the amount every year.

Social Security and **Social Security (combined).** The field is one annual dollar amount. The planner does not estimate the benefit. The benefit starts when your age reaches **Start Age**. **Start Age** runs from 62 to 70. **Start Age** is not your spouse's age.

State. The menu lists the 50 states and the District of Columbia. State tax rules are under Tax rules the numbers use.

Accounts

Each account card has the same fields, with the exceptions below. The chart calls the taxable account **Taxable Brokerage**. The tab calls it **Taxable**. They are the same account.

Header switch. On, the account takes contributions, growth, and withdrawals. Off, the balance is treated as $0.

Current Balance. The balance at the start of 2026.

Rate of Return. Annual percent. Growth is that percent times the balance after the year's contribution and withdrawal.

Annual Contribution. The field is the dollars added in a year while contributions continue. After 2026, the typed amount grows by 3% a year. The IRS limit in the label uses your age in 2026, including that age's catch-up. Later years do not add a new catch-up. The planner does not reduce an amount above the limit.

The 2026 bases, before catch-up, are:

- Roth IRA, $7,500
- HSA, $4,400 on a single return
- HSA, $4,375 for each spouse, half of the $8,750 family limit
- 401(k), $24,500

Catch-up in the label is $1,100 on a Roth IRA from age 50, and $1,000 on an HSA from age 55. On a 401(k) it is $8,000 from age 50, or $11,250 at ages 60, 61, 62, and 63 instead of $8,000.

Changing **Filing Status** to **Married** sets each HSA contribution to $4,375. Changing it to **Single** sets your HSA contribution to $4,400. Changing **Year of Birth** or **Spouse Birth Year** updates a contribution only when the field still equals the old limit.

The planner does not compare the two HSA amounts with the $8,750 family limit.

Employer Match. Only on a 401(k). It is added on top of **Annual Contribution** and grows 3% a year. It starts at $0.

Stop Contributing at Age. This age stops an HSA. It does not stop a Roth IRA, a 401(k), or the taxable account. Those stop in **Retirement Year**.

Start Withdrawing at Age. A scheduled withdrawal starts at this age. An amount of $0 withdraws nothing.

Use %. When **Use %** is on, the label is **Withdrawal %**. The withdrawal is that percent of the balance after the year's contribution. When **Use %** is off, the label is **Annual Withdrawal**. The withdrawal is that many dollars. A dollar withdrawal does not grow by 3%.

Pay Roth Conversion Taxes from Taxable Account. Only on a 401(k). When the switch is on, that person's conversion tax must come from the taxable account, or the exact search rejects the plan. When the switch is off, the tax is withheld from that person's Roth conversion. The Roth IRA receives less than the gross conversion. The planner takes tax on a required distribution from the taxable account, up to the cash in that account. The switch does not change that rule.

Pre-RMD Roth Conversions. Conversions before the required-distribution age. The switch must be on, the 401(k) must be on, the year must be retired, and the person must be 60 or older. The bracket menu is 10%, 12%, 22%, 24%, 32%, 35%, and 37%. A bracket below 37% stops the conversion before the next dollar would be taxed above that rate. The 37% bracket does not add that stop.

RMD Roth Conversions. The same rules, from the required-distribution age on. Turning the switch off does not stop the required distribution.

IRMAA Bracket Cap. The menu appears when either conversion period is on. **No IRMAA cap** means the conversion ignores IRMAA. A named tier stops Roth conversions at that MAGI. MAGI is the income Medicare uses. If both of you can convert and both have a finite cap, the lower cap applies. If the required distribution is already over the cap, the conversion that year is $0 and the distribution is still taken. The tiers and dollar caps are in the IRMAA panel.

Maximize ending money

Maximize ending money. This switch is on your 401(k) card. When the switch is on, the planner chooses each year's Roth conversion. The planner maximizes the money left at **Maximize at age**. The table runs through longevity. If **Maximize at age** is later than longevity, the table runs through that age too. After

Maximize at age there are no more conversions. The planner still takes required distributions, and it still takes the withdrawals you entered.

Turning the switch on can change conversion settings. If both of a person's periods are off, both periods turn on. Both brackets become 37%. **Pay Roth Conversion Taxes from Taxable Account** turns on. You and your spouse are each changed this way. If either period is already on, that person is left as entered.

Maximize at age. Your age, not your spouse's age. The hint says the table still runs through longevity.

Total and **Spendable** slider. The left end is **Total**. A 401(k) or HSA dollar counts as a dollar while the planner chooses conversions. The right end is **Spendable**. That dollar counts only after tax, penalty, and extra IRMAA to cash it out. A point between the ends counts that percent of the cash-out cost. The search uses the value when you release the handle. The **Total** column and the **Spendable** column do not change meaning.

The status box appears only while the switch is on.

- While the search runs, the status box is blue and reads "Maximizing. The table updates as a better plan is found."
- At **Total**, a green status box says "Exact plan. Conversions maximize the total money left at age" and then the age. The next sentence is "A 401(k) or HSA is counted in full."
- At **Spendable**, a green status box says "Exact plan. Conversions maximize the spendable money left at age" and then the age, then "after the tax to cash out pretax accounts."
- Between the ends, the green status box uses that same opening, then states the percent of the cash-out cost.
- An amber status box reads "Showing the best plan found. The exact search did not finish, so this may not be the proven maximum."

The exact search stops after 60 seconds.

The cards above the chart

At Retirement. Total balance in the retirement year, at the age **Retirement Year** minus **Year of Birth**.

Peak Portfolio Value. The highest **Total** in the table, with the age and year of that row.

Dividends at Retirement. 2% of the taxable balance in the retirement year, rounded to thousands of dollars. This figure is not a withdrawal, and it is not added to income.

Years to Retirement. Your retirement age minus your age in 2026. The detail line repeats the retirement age. The value is never below 0.

Portfolio growth

Portfolio Growth. A stacked chart of ending balances by year, for the 401(k), the Roth IRA, the HSA, and **Taxable Brokerage**. Resting on a year shows each balance and the total. When **Spouse Birth Year** is set, the tip also shows your age and your spouse's age.

Year-by-year projection

Year-by-Year Projection. The tabs are **Summary**, **Roth IRA**, **HSA**, **401(k)**, and **Taxable**. The right edge of a heading resizes that column. A heading that has a definition shows it when the pointer rests on the heading.

The **Age** column is your age. When **Spouse Birth Year** is set, **Age** is your age, then your spouse's age, including years before **Marriage Year**.

A selected row is highlighted. A click in **Summary** selects the year for the spendable panel. A click on the **401(k)** tab selects the year for the IRMAA panel.

Summary columns

Year and **Age.** The calendar year and the ages above.

Roth IRA, **HSA**, **401(k)**, and **Taxable.** Ending balances. Spouses are combined in each column. The taxable column is the household account.

Total. The four ending balances added together.

Spendable. Total after the cost of cashing out the 401(k) and HSA balances that remain. Roth IRA and taxable balances count in full. The cost is the extra federal tax, the extra state tax, this year's IRMAA, and the extra IRMAA two years later. A 401(k) cashed out before age 60 also loses 10%. An HSA spent on non-medical costs before age 65 also loses 20%. The panel under the table shows the arithmetic for the selected year.

AGI. Other income, plus the taxable part of Social Security, plus required distributions, plus Roth conversions. This is not the number in **Adjusted Gross Income** unless those other pieces are $0.

Federal Tax and **State Tax.** Tax on that year's income. The income is other income, the taxable part of Social Security, required distributions, and Roth conversions. Growth inside an account is not taxed that year. A withdrawal from a Roth IRA, an HSA, or the taxable account is not added to this income.

Net Income. Other income, plus the full Social Security benefit, plus required distributions, plus Roth conversions, minus federal tax and state tax. IRMAA is not subtracted here.

IRMAA. The Medicare surcharge for the year, in dollars and cents. IRMAA is the extra Part B and Part D premium tied to income from two years earlier. The cell is a dash when that earlier year is outside the projection. The $202.90 standard Part B premium is not included.

Account columns

Roth IRA, HSA, and Taxable show **Year**, **Age**, **Starting Balance**, **Contribution**, **Withdrawal**, **Growth**, and **Ending Balance**. A zero contribution, withdrawal, or growth is a dash.

The **401(k)** tab adds **RMD** and **IRMAA Income**. **Withdrawal** on that tab is the required distribution, Roth conversions, and any scheduled withdrawal. **RMD** is the required minimum distribution only. **IRMAA Income** is other income, plus taxable Social Security, plus required distributions, plus Roth conversions. That figure sets the IRMAA two years later.

A required distribution leaves the 401(k). The amount after tax on that distribution is added to the taxable account when **Taxable** is on. When **Taxable** is off, that cash is not added to another account on the chart.

A Roth conversion leaves the 401(k). It is deposited in the Roth IRA when that account is on, minus any tax withheld from the conversion. When the Roth IRA is off, the conversion is not deposited there.

Spendable panel

How the spendable amount was calculated is under **Summary**. The panel uses the selected year.

Balances at the end of the year. Roth IRA, Taxable, 401(k), and HSA. **Total** is the sum. When **Spouse Birth Year** is set, the 401(k) line splits into **401(k), you** and **401(k), spouse**. The HSA line splits the same way.

Cost of cashing out what is left. The lines are:

- **Federal tax on this year's income**
- **Federal tax if 401(k) and HSA are cashed out**
- **State tax on this year's income**
- **State tax if 401(k) and HSA are cashed out**
- **Extra income tax**
- **401(k) early-withdrawal penalty**
- **HSA non-medical penalty**
- **IRMAA due in** the selected year
- **IRMAA in** the year two years later **from this year's income**
- **IRMAA in** that later year **if 401(k) and HSA are cashed out**
- **Extra IRMAA from cashing out**
- **Spendable**

Extra income tax is the difference between the federal pair and the state pair. The 401(k) penalty is 10% of a 401(k) balance when that person is under 60. The HSA penalty is 20% of an HSA balance when that person is under 65. **Extra IRMAA from cashing out** is the difference between the two later IRMAA lines. **Spendable** is **Total** minus extra income tax, the penalties, this year's IRMAA, and extra IRMAA.

This year's ordinary income tax stays in **Net Income**. It is not subtracted again from the ending balances. If this year's IRMAA depends on a year before the projection, that IRMAA is not subtracted. If nobody in the projection is on Medicare two years later, cashing out adds no later IRMAA.

Federal tax by bracket

This block is at the bottom of the spendable panel. Each line is a rate, the ordinary income taxed at that rate after the deduction, and the tax. The lines add up to the federal tax in the cost list.

When cashing out would not change the brackets, one list appears, labeled **This year's income**. When it would, a second list appears, labeled **If the 401(k) and HSA are cashed out**. If the deduction covers the income, the list says "No federal tax. The deduction covers this income."

IRMAA panel

How IRMAA was calculated is under the **401(k)** table. The panel uses the selected year. The fee in a year uses MAGI from two years earlier. The 2028 surcharge uses 2026 IRMAA income. The brackets are 2026 CMS amounts, and they are not inflated.

IRMAA income in the year. Other income, **Taxable Social Security**, **RMD**, **Roth conversions**, and **IRMAA MAGI**. **Other income** is **Adjusted Gross Income** for that year, after **Only the first year**. **IRMAA MAGI** is the sum of the four pieces. The note under the lines says this MAGI sets the premium two years later. Tax-exempt interest is not an input, so this MAGI matches the **AGI** column.

IRMAA fee paid in the year. People age 65 or older are on Medicare. Before **Marriage Year**, your spouse is not counted, and the year is single. If nobody is 65 yet, the fee is $0. If the lookback year is before the projection, the surcharge is not calculated.

When the lookback year is inside the projection, the panel names that year and its MAGI. It names the filing status and the tier. It names the Part B monthly surcharge and the Part D monthly surcharge. The annual fee is the monthly sum, times 12, times the number of people on Medicare. The surcharge is on top of the $202.90 standard Part B premium. That standard premium is not in the fee.

MAGI at or below a tier's top stays in that tier. The conversion cap for a tier is the number in the menu.

Menu tier	Single cap	Married cap	Surcharge per person each month
Standard	$109,000	$218,000	$0.00
Tier 1	$137,000	$274,000	$95.70
Tier 2	$171,000	$342,000	$240.40
Tier 3	$205,000	$410,000	$385.00
Tier 4	$499,999	$749,999	$529.60

Tier 5 is not in the menu, because it has no cap. MAGI of $500,000 or more on a single return, or $750,000 or more on a married return, is Tier 5. The monthly surcharge is $578.00 per person. The projection still uses Tier 5. The menu cannot stop a conversion at Tier 5.

Save and load

Copy writes the plan to the clipboard. **Paste** reads the clipboard. **Save** downloads `retirement-plan.json`. **Load** reads a JSON file. The page does not store the plan on its own.

If the plan on the page differs from the last load, **Load** and **Paste** ask "Are you sure? This will replace the plan on this page." Cancel shows "Load canceled" and leaves the page alone. A bad file shows "Not valid JSON." or "This is not a retirement plan." **Copy** can show "Copied to clipboard" or "Couldn't copy. Check clipboard permission." **Paste** can show "Couldn't read the clipboard." **Load** can show "Couldn't read that file." **Save** shows "Saved retirement-plan.json". A successful load shows "Loaded from" and then the file name or "the clipboard".

What the page opens with

You are born in 1955, so you are 71 in 2026. Your spouse is born in 1960. **Filing Status** is **Married**, and **Marriage Year** is 2026. **Retirement Year** is 2026. Both longevity ages are 100. **State** is Georgia. **Adjusted Gross Income** is $0, and **Only the first year** is clear. **Social Security** is $0, and **Start Age** is 67.

Maximize ending money is off. **Maximize at age** is 90.

The slider starts at **Spendable**. Your 401(k) is on. Your spouse's 401(k) is off. Rates of return start at 8%. Roth IRA, HSA, and 401(k) contributions start at the 2026 limit for that person's age. The taxable contribution starts at $24,000, with **Use %** on and the percent at 0.

Tax rules the numbers use

Brackets, the standard deduction, Social Security thresholds, and IRMAA stay at 2026 amounts in every year. Contribution dollars and employer match grow by 3% a year after 2026. Those two growth rules are not the same thing.

Income in a year is other income, the taxable part of Social Security, 401(k) required distributions, and Roth conversions. A required distribution is an RMD. The RMD age depends on birth year.

- Born in 1960 or later, age 75
- Born from 1951 to 1959, age 73
- Born in 1949 or 1950, age 72
- Born before 1949, age 70

The federal standard deduction is $16,100 single and $32,200 married. A single person who is 65 or older gets $2,050 more. In a married year, each person who is 65 or older gets $1,650 more.

An extra senior deduction applies if you are 65 or older, or your spouse is. When both of you are 65 or older and the year is married, the amount is $12,000. It falls in a straight line from $150,000 to $250,000, and it is $0 at $250,000. In every other case the amount is $6,000. It falls in a straight line from $75,000 to $175,000, and it is $0 at $175,000. The income that shrinks it is other income plus required distributions plus Roth conversions. Social Security is not in that test.

Federal tax uses ordinary brackets on taxable income after those deductions. The tops of the brackets are:

Rate	Single taxable income through	Married taxable income through
10%	$12,400	$24,800
12%	$50,400	$100,800
22%	$105,700	$211,400
24%	$201,775	$403,550
32%	$256,225	$512,450
35%	$640,600	$768,700
37%	No top	No top

Social Security can be partly taxable. Provisional income is other income, plus required distributions, plus Roth conversions, plus half the benefit. None of the benefit is taxable below $25,000 single, or below $32,000 married. Up to half the benefit is taxable from $25,000 to $34,000 single, and from $32,000 to $44,000 married. Above $34,000 single, or above $44,000 married, up to 85% of the benefit is taxable. The taxable part is the **Taxable Social Security** line.

Nine places charge no income tax in this planner. They are Alaska, Florida, Nevada, New Hampshire, South Dakota, Tennessee, Texas, Washington, and Wyoming.

Georgia tax is 4.99% of Georgia taxable income. Social Security is exempt. The deduction is $15,000 single and $30,000 married. From age 62, a retirement exclusion of $35,000 applies. From age 65, that exclusion is $65,000. Each person's exclusion covers only that person's own 401(k) distributions. **Adjusted Gross Income** counts toward your exclusion, not toward your spouse's.

Ohio charges no tax on the first $26,050. Above that, the tax is $332 plus 2.75% of the amount over $26,050.

Every other state uses its own 2026 bracket schedule.

What the planner leaves out

The page does not store the plan. A plan remains if you use **Save**, use **Copy**, or keep a file.

Social Security is a number you type. Roth IRA contributions have no income limit.

Tax brackets, the standard deduction, Social Security thresholds, and IRMAA stay at the 2026 amounts. A later birthday does not add a catch-up.

Growth inside an account is not taxed. A withdrawal from a Roth IRA, an HSA, or the taxable account is not added to that year's income. **Spendable** still subtracts the cost of cashing out the 401(k) and HSA balances that remain.

The **IRMAA** column omits the $202.90 standard Part B premium. Tax-exempt interest is not its own field. **Dividends at Retirement** is not income, and it is not a withdrawal.